Advanced Punctuation

Year 4 · **Lesson Worksheet**

Worked Examples

Easy: Punctuate the speech: "I am hungry said Ben."

Answer: "I am hungry," said Ben. (speech marks around the spoken words, comma before "said")

Standard: Add a colon: "She needed three things a pencil a ruler and a rubber."

Answer: She needed three things: a pencil, a ruler and a rubber. (the colon introduces a list)

Advanced: Add a semicolon to join these two related sentences: "The sky was dark. Rain was on the way."

Answer: The sky was dark; rain was on the way.

Easy / Standard (15 questions)

1. Add speech marks: "Hello said Anna."
2. Add speech marks: "I am tired he said."
3. Which correctly punctuates: A) "He packed one thing, his football." B) He packed one thing: his football. C) He packed one thing; his football. D) He packed one thing his football.
4. Add speech marks: "Come here called Mum."
5. Add a colon before this list: "We need eggs, flour and sugar." (add the colon after "need")
6. Which correctly punctuates this speech? A) "That's amazing," exclaimed Sam. B) That's amazing exclaimed Sam. C) "That's amazing" exclaimed Sam. D) That's amazing, exclaimed Sam.
7. Join with a semicolon: "It was cold. We wore coats."
8. Add speech marks: "Be careful warned Dad."
9. Select ALL the sentences below that correctly use a colon to introduce a single item: A) He needed one thing: courage. B) He needed one thing, courage. C) She packed: a hat, a scarf. D) There was one winner: Priya. E) There was one winner Priya.
10. Add speech marks: "I love this book said Leo."
11. Join with a semicolon: "The dog barked. The cat hid."
12. Which correctly punctuates this speech? A) "Where are we going?" asked Tom. B) Where are we going, asked Tom. C) "Where are we going" asked Tom? D) Where are we going? asked Tom.
13. Add a colon: "She had one wish to fly."
14. Which correctly punctuates this speech? A) "Well done," said the coach. B) "Well done" said the coach. C) Well done, said the coach. D) "Well done." said the coach
15. Join with a semicolon: "The sun set. The stars appeared."

Standard (15 questions)

1. Punctuate correctly: "Are you coming asked Priya I hope so."

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2. Which correctly completes: He had only one rule ___ never be late. A) , B) : C) ; D) !

3. Join with a semicolon: "The exam was hard. Most pupils did well anyway."

4. Punctuate: "Stop right there shouted the guard."

5. Rewrite with correct new lines for speech: "Hello said Sam. Hi replied Jess."

6. Add a colon: "The recipe needed three ingredients butter sugar and flour."

7. Which mark correctly joins these two closely related sentences? She practised every day ___ her skills improved quickly. A) , B) ; C) : D) !

8. Punctuate: "I can't believe it whispered Ali."

9. Select ALL the sentences below that correctly use a colon to introduce an explanation: A) He was late: one reason his alarm hadn't gone off. B) He was late, one reason his alarm hadn't gone off. C) The teacher gave one instruction: be quiet. D) The teacher gave one instruction, be quiet. E) She had one wish: to fly.

10. Punctuate: "Watch out for the step warned the guide."

11. Join with a semicolon: "The museum was fascinating. We stayed for hours."

12. Which correctly punctuates this speech? A) "What time is it?" he asked nervously. B) "What time is it" he asked nervously? C) What time is it, he asked nervously. D) "What time is it?" He asked nervously.

13. Add a colon: "The teacher gave one instruction be quiet."

14. Which correctly punctuates this speech? A) "I did it!" she cried with joy. B) I did it! she cried with joy. C) "I did it" she cried with joy! D) "I did it," She cried with joy!

15. Join with a semicolon: "The bakery smelled wonderful. Everyone wanted to go inside."

Standard / Hard (15 questions)

1. Punctuate this speech correctly: "Are you ready asked Maya."

2. Which mark correctly completes this, and why? "She had one goal ___ to win." A) comma B) semicolon C) colon — it introduces an explanation of the goal D) dash

3. Use a semicolon to join two closely related ideas: "The storm passed. The sun came out."

4. Add a colon and correct the list punctuation: "The bag contained the following items a torch a map and a compass."

5. Which mark correctly joins these two sentences without using "and"? "The rain stopped ___ the birds began to sing." A) , B) : C) ; D) !

6. Punctuate this speech, which is interrupted by a reporting clause: "I think said Leo that we should turn back."

7. Select ALL that apply. Which of the sentences below correctly use semicolons to separate items in a list that already has commas? A) The winners were: Amir, first place; Priya, second place; and Leo, third place. B) The winners were Amir, first place, Priya, second place, and Leo, third place. C) She packed a tent; a stove; and a torch. D) The winners were Amir first place Priya second place and Leo third place. E) The team included Sam, who ran fast; Priya, who jumped high; and Leo, who threw far.

8. Punctuate correctly, including the exclamation inside the speech: "Run he yelled the bridge is collapsing."

9. Explain the punctuation error here and correct it: "She said, that she was tired."

10. Which mark correctly introduces the explanation in this sentence? "There was only one explanation for the mess ___ the puppy had got into the bin." A) , B) ; C) : D) .

11. Punctuate this speech correctly: "Did you see that gasped Ana."

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12. Which is the more formal way to join these two sentences, replacing "and"? A) The library was silent, nobody dared to whisper. B) The library was silent; nobody dared to whisper. C) The library was silent nobody dared to whisper. D) The library was silent: nobody dared to whisper.

13. Punctuate this speech, which is split by a reporting clause in the middle: "Watch out said Grandpa for the ice on the path."

14. Explain why this sentence is incorrectly punctuated, then rewrite it correctly: The teacher said, "you must all be quiet"

15. Punctuate this speech correctly: "Good morning she said cheerfully."

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